

foreseeable future, we must simultaneously prepare for a cleaner energy future.

CCL has set an ambitious target of developing 425 MW of solar power capacity. Our 20 MW solar plant at Piparwar is already generating nearly 28 lakh units of electricity every month, contributing to energy savings.

At Balkudra in the Barka-Sayal area, we are converting overburden dump land into a solar energy site. This demonstrates how land impacted by mining can subsequently be repurposed for productive clean-energy generation.

We are also pursuing a proposed 100 MW solar project in Giridih, which is expected to be among the largest solar installations developed by a Coal India subsidiary. These initiatives represent our commitment to diversifying our energy footprint while continuing to meet the country's immediate energy requirements.

Beyond mining and energy, how is CCL contributing to the development of communities in Jharkhand?

Our responsibility extends well beyond our operational boundaries. CCL's CSR expenditure exceeded Rs 81 crore in FY 2025-26, supporting healthcare, education, nutrition, livelihoods and sports.

Healthcare remains a priority, particularly in remote mining regions. We are constructing a 200-bed Super Speciality Hospital at Kanke, Ranchi, with advanced cardiology and neurology facilities. Through the Nanha Sa Dil programme, children across districts such as Latehar, Ramgarh, Giridih, Hazaribagh and Palamu are screened for congenital heart disease, with identified cases supported for treatment and surgery.

Through Upachar Aapke Dwar, Mobile Medical Units and health camps are taking healthcare services directly to remote communities. We are also supporting TB patients through the Government of India's Nikshay Mitra programme and undertaking sickle-cell anaemia screening through Project Aditi in vulnerable tribal regions.

Education is an important component of inclusive development. What are CCL's key initiatives in this area?

Education creates the human capital required for long-term development. Through Digital Vidya, we are establishing smart classrooms and ICT laboratories in government schools, helping rural students access modern learning resources.

CCL Ke Lal and CCL Ki Laadli is another flagship initiative. It provides meritorious students from economically weaker sections with free residential

coaching, schooling, accommodation, food and healthcare support for engineering entrance examinations.

We are also developing what is expected to become Jharkhand's largest library, with seating capacity for around 5,000 readers. In Ramgarh, our partnership with the Akshaya Patra Foundation is supporting a centralised kitchen that will provide approximately 50,000 mid-day meals every day to government school students.

How is CCL empowering young people through sports and livelihood programmes?

We believe that inclusive development must create opportunities for young people. The Jharkhand State Sports Promotion Society (JSSPS) Sports Academy, supported by CCL and the Government of Jharkhand, provides professional coaching, education, accommodation, nutrition and medical support to talented athletes, particularly from rural and tribal backgrounds.

Athletes associated with the academy have won medals at national and international levels, demonstrating the potential that exists when talent receives structured support.

Our livelihood programmes focus on skill development, computer training, sustainable agriculture, livestock management, fisheries and entrepreneurship. Several initiatives specifically target SC, ST and economically weaker youth, creating opportunities for employment and self-employment.

What does CCL's journey tell us about the future of responsible mining in India?

The role of a modern public sector enterprise cannot be defined only by production or financial performance. It must also be measured by its contribution to society, environment and national development.

CCL today is simultaneously an energy supplier, infrastructure developer, environmental steward, healthcare supporter, education partner and community institution. Our experience demonstrates that energy security and sustainability need not be viewed as competing objectives.

India's energy transition will take time and will require technology, innovation, policy alignment and institutional accountability. Until then, responsible coal mining must continue to support economic growth while reducing its environmental footprint. Our vision is therefore to build a mining ecosystem where production, technology, environmental restoration and community development move together. From ensuring coal supply to thermal power plants and developing solar capacity, to reclaiming mined land, supporting healthcare, nurturing students, developing athletes and strengthening livelihoods, CCL's contribution extends far beyond mining.

For us, mining with purpose means powering India's present while preparing responsibly for its future.

